TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Column Break — Authoring Guide

Role / audience	Authoring — Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
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Column Break — Authoring Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	AUT-C-column-break
Audience	Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Purpose	How to add, fill in and check the Column Break component
Scope	—
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
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Source files	blocks/column-break/README.md, blocks/column-break/_column-break.json
Related documents	—
Related AEM paths	—

1. Where to see it

No block library page.

2. For Content Authors

1. Select a **Columns Container** (or a **Tabs Container**, after a Tab) in the content tree, choose Add (+) and pick **Column Break**.
2. Add the components of the column after it.
3. Add the next Column Break, then that column's components, and so on.
4. Optionally open the Column Break's properties: in **Content** enter a **Column name** (shown in the editor only); in **Additional** set the column's **Anchor ID**, **Hide block** and **Padding / Margin**.
5. To move a column, move its Column Break together with its components.
6. Preview the page at desktop and mobile widths; publish; on the published page check that no label is visible and the columns are as expected.

Minimum required: none of its fields; the Column Break itself, followed by the column's components. **Recommended:** a Column name per column on pages with several columns. **Optional:** the Additional tab.

3. Authorable Fields

Column Break (`column-break`)

Model `column-break`; template name "Column Break" (the block class AEM renders); key-value block (one row per property).

Content tab — Column Break

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Column name	`title`	text	No	—	—	Shown in the editor only, to tell the columns apart (e.g. Contact details). Not shown on the page.	Grey Teaser

Additional tab — Column Break

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Anchor ID	`classes_anchor`	text	No	—	regExp: ^anchor-[a-z0-9][a-z0-9-]*$; customErrorMsg: Start with anchor-, then lower-case letters, digits and hyphens.	A unique ID of the block on the page, starting with anchor-, e.g. anchor-our-services; link to it with #anchor-our-services. Delivered as a block class.	—
Hide block	`classes_hideblock`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	Hides the whole block on the page until it is turned off (shown faded in the editor). Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding left	`classes_paddingleft`	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (`pl-0`), 0.25rem (space-100) (`pl-100`), 0.5rem (space-200) (`pl-200`), 0.75rem (space-300) (`pl-300`), 1rem (space-400) (`pl-400`), 1.25rem (space-500) (`pl-500`), 1.5rem (space-600) (`pl-600`), 2rem (space-800) (`pl-800`), 2.5rem (space-1000) (`pl-1000`), 3rem (space-1200) (`pl-1200`), 4rem (space-1600) (`pl-1600`), 5rem (space-2000) (`pl-2000`), 6rem (space-2400) (`pl-2400`), 7.5rem (space-3000) (`pl-3000`)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding right	`classes_paddingright`	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (`pr-0`), 0.25rem (space-100) (`pr-100`), 0.5rem (space-200) (`pr-200`), 0.75rem (space-300) (`pr-300`), 1rem (space-400) (`pr-400`), 1.25rem (space-500) (`pr-500`), 1.5rem (space-600) (`pr-600`), 2rem (space-800) (`pr-800`), 2.5rem (space-1000) (`pr-1000`), 3rem (space-1200) (`pr-1200`), 4rem (space-1600) (`pr-1600`), 5rem (space-2000) (`pr-2000`), 6rem (space-2400) (`pr-2400`), 7.5rem (space-3000) (`pr-3000`)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding top	`classes_paddingtop`	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (`pt-0`), 0.25rem (space-100) (`pt-100`), 0.5rem (space-200) (`pt-200`), 0.75rem (space-300) (`pt-300`), 1rem (space-400) (`pt-400`), 1.25rem (space-500) (`pt-500`), 1.5rem (space-600) (`pt-600`), 2rem (space-800) (`pt-800`), 2.5rem (space-1000) (`pt-1000`), 3rem (space-1200) (`pt-1200`), 4rem (space-1600) (`pt-1600`), 5rem (space-2000) (`pt-2000`), 6rem (space-2400) (`pt-2400`), 7.5rem (space-3000) (`pt-3000`)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Padding bottom	`classes_paddingbottom`	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (`pb-0`), 0.25rem (space-100) (`pb-100`), 0.5rem (space-200) (`pb-200`), 0.75rem (space-300) (`pb-300`), 1rem (space-400) (`pb-400`), 1.25rem (space-500) (`pb-500`), 1.5rem (space-600) (`pb-600`), 2rem (space-800) (`pb-800`), 2.5rem (space-1000) (`pb-1000`), 3rem (space-1200) (`pb-1200`), 4rem (space-1600) (`pb-1600`), 5rem (space-2000) (`pb-2000`), 6rem (space-2400) (`pb-2400`), 7.5rem (space-3000) (`pb-3000`)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin left	`classes_marginleft`	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (`ml-0`), 0.25rem (space-100) (`ml-100`), 0.5rem (space-200) (`ml-200`), 0.75rem (space-300) (`ml-300`), 1rem (space-400) (`ml-400`), 1.25rem (space-500) (`ml-500`), 1.5rem (space-600) (`ml-600`), 2rem (space-800) (`ml-800`), 2.5rem (space-1000) (`ml-1000`), 3rem (space-1200) (`ml-1200`), 4rem (space-1600) (`ml-1600`), 5rem (space-2000) (`ml-2000`), 6rem (space-2400) (`ml-2400`), 7.5rem (space-3000) (`ml-3000`)	Delivered as a block class.	—

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Margin right	classes_marginright	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mr-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mr-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mr-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mr-300), 1rem (space-400) (mr-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mr-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mr-600), 2rem (space-800) (mr-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mr-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mr-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mr-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mr-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mr-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mr-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin top	classes_margintop	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mt-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mt-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mt-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mt-300), 1rem (space-400) (mt-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mt-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mt-600), 2rem (space-800) (mt-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mt-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mt-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mt-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mt-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mt-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mt-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—
Margin bottom	classes_marginbottom	select	No	""	Default (""), 0 (none) (mb-0), 0.25rem (space-100) (mb-100), 0.5rem (space-200) (mb-200), 0.75rem (space-300) (mb-300), 1rem (space-400) (mb-400), 1.25rem (space-500) (mb-500), 1.5rem (space-600) (mb-600), 2rem (space-800) (mb-800), 2.5rem (space-1000) (mb-1000), 3rem (space-1200) (mb-1200), 4rem (space-1600) (mb-1600), 5rem (space-2000) (mb-2000), 6rem (space-2400) (mb-2400), 7.5rem (space-3000) (mb-3000)	Delivered as a block class.	—

Notes on the fields:

- **Column name** (`title`): the label in edit mode; empty: "Column {n}" (placeholder `columnLabel`, n = the column's position). Not on the page, not in the data layer.
- **Anchor ID** (`classes_anchor`): the id moves from the Column Break to its column, so `#anchor-…` links jump to the column.
- **Hide block** (`classes_hideblock`): copied to the column: the column is hidden on the page and dimmed in edit mode.
- **Padding / Margin** (`classes_padding*`, `classes_margin*`): copied to the column (`pl-400`, `mt-800`, …; `styles/styles.css` applies them to `.columns-container-column`).
- **Additional tab:** see AGENTS.md "Additional tab"; the Column Break has no animation fields (the container's Animation Type moves the columns).
- **Legacy mapping:** items authored when this item was named "Column" are rendered with the class `column`; in a Columns Container section they are read as Column Breaks. `readColumn` reads a key-value `title` row, else the last cell of the first row.

4. Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps

Authoring Step 1: Add the first Column Break

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
column-break-authoring-step-1.png

Purpose:
A Columns Container selected in the content tree, Add (+) open with Column Break highlighted.

Annotations:
A = Columns Container in the tree
B = Column Break in the list
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
B	Add (+)	Column Break	Starts the first column	An outlined column with the hint "Add the components of this column after it."

Author action: add the Column Break. Expected preview: an empty outlined column (edit mode). Published: nothing until it has content. Business rule: it is the first item of its column. Common mistake: adding the column's components before it; resolution: move them after it.

Authoring Step 2: Name the column and add its content

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
column-break-authoring-step-2.png

Purpose:
The Column Break's Content tab with Column name entered, and a Teaser added after it.

Annotations:
A = Column name
B = Label in the canvas
C = Component after the Column Break
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Column name	Grey Teaser	Tells the columns apart in the editor	Label "Grey Teaser" (edit mode only)
C	Component after it	Teaser	The column's content	Teaser in the column

Author action: enter the name; add the components after the Column Break. Expected preview: the label and the content in the column. Published: the content only. Common mistake: expecting the name on the page; it is an editor label only.

Authoring Step 3: Add the next column

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
column-break-authoring-step-3.png

Purpose:
The content tree with two Column Breaks, each followed by its components, and the two columns side by
side.

Annotations:
A = Second Column Break
B = Its components
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Column name	Contact details	Second column	Label "Contact details"
B	Components	Title, Text	Its content	Shown in column 2

Author action: add a Column Break after the first column's content, then its components. Expected preview and published result: two columns (side by side from the container's breakpoint, 900px by default). Common mistake: a component dragged above the second Column Break ends in the first column; resolution: check the tree order.

Authoring Step 4: Column options

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
column-break-authoring-step-4.png

Purpose:
The Column Break's Additional tab with Anchor ID anchor-contact and Padding top 1rem (space-400).

Annotations:
A = Anchor ID
B = Hide block
C = Padding top
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Anchor ID	anchor-contact	Links to the column	The column has `id="anchor-contact"`
C	Padding top	1rem (space-400)	Space above the column's content	Class `pt-400` on the column

Author action: set the options. Expected preview: applied after the section is rendered again (reload the editor; re-audit R-C-7). Published: applied. Common mistake: an Anchor ID without the `anchor-` prefix (rejected by the validation).

5. Variations

Named or unnamed Column Break

With a Column name the editor label is the name; without, "Column {n}". No difference on the page.

In a Columns Container

The Columns Container's Layout (Columns per row, Gap, Vertical alignment, Side by side from) applies to the columns. See Columns Container.

In a tab of a Tabs Container

After a Tab, Column Breaks lay the tab's content out in columns with the Tab's Columns per row; content between the Tab and the first Column Break stays above the columns. Gap medium, top alignment, side by side from 900px.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
column-break-in-tab-desktop.png

Purpose:
A tab with a heading and two Column Breaks: the heading above, two columns below.

Annotations:
```

```
A = Heading before the first Column Break
B = Two columns
```

Column options (Additional tab)

Anchor ID, Hide block and spacing apply to the column, not to the hidden Column Break.

6. Complete Authoring Example

Scenario: the second column of an "Our offices" Columns Container holds the contact details and is linked from the page's Anchor List.

Field	Example value	Guidance
Column name	Contact details	Editor label only
Anchor ID	anchor-contact	Starts with `anchor-`; unique on the page
Hide block	Off	—
Padding top	1rem (space-400)	Optional
Components after it	Title "Contact us", Text with the address	Start with a heading

Steps: Authoring Steps 1 to 4. Expected output: a column with the heading and address, `id="anchor-contact"`; an Anchor List link to `#anchor-contact` jumps to it (and opens its tab if the columns are in a tab). Responsive: stacked below the container's breakpoint. Accessibility: the column's heading follows the page's heading order. Analytics: the Column Break isn't tracked; the components are. Personalization fallback: none.

Pre-publish checklist: every column starts with a Column Break; the Anchor ID is unique; nothing sits between a Column Break and the wrong components.

7. Content and Asset Guidelines

- **Column name:** a short label for authors (e.g. "Contact details"); not translated for visitors (not shown).
- **Anchor ID:** `anchor-` followed by lower-case letters, digits and hyphens (validated).
- **Content:** whatever the parent allows; start a column with a heading when it is its own topic.
- **Images, CTAs, tags:** none on the Column Break.
- **Min / max:** no verified technical limit was identified; the container shows at most 4 columns per row.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
No columns	The Column Break is in a normal Section	Check the section class	Use a Columns Container	Columns appear
Label visible on the page	Edit mode (`html.adobe-ue-edit`) or CSS not loaded	Check the published page	—	Hidden on the page
Option changes not shown in the editor	Applied when the section is rendered again (R-C-7)	Reload	Reload	Applied
Content in the wrong column	Its position in the tree	Check the tree order	Move it after its Column Break	Correct column
Anchor link doesn't jump	Anchor ID taken (suffix `-2`) or mistyped	Inspect the column id	Use a unique ID	Link jumps

Evidence to collect: page URL, the column's classes and id, the Column Break's `data-column-title`.

9. Screenshots

> **Screenshot required**
>
> - Required screen: Column Break dialog in Universal Editor (every tab, including Additional)
> - Required role/access: AEM Sites author with Universal Editor (content author)
> - Required navigation steps: AEM Sites console > /content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en > open a page in Universal Editor
> - Reason unavailable: No AEM author access in the documentation program (access blocker AB-01)
> - Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
> - Target completion date: To be confirmed

10. Known limitations

- Universal Editor screenshots are placeholders: no author access in this program.

11. Open items

- None.

12. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	8 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages